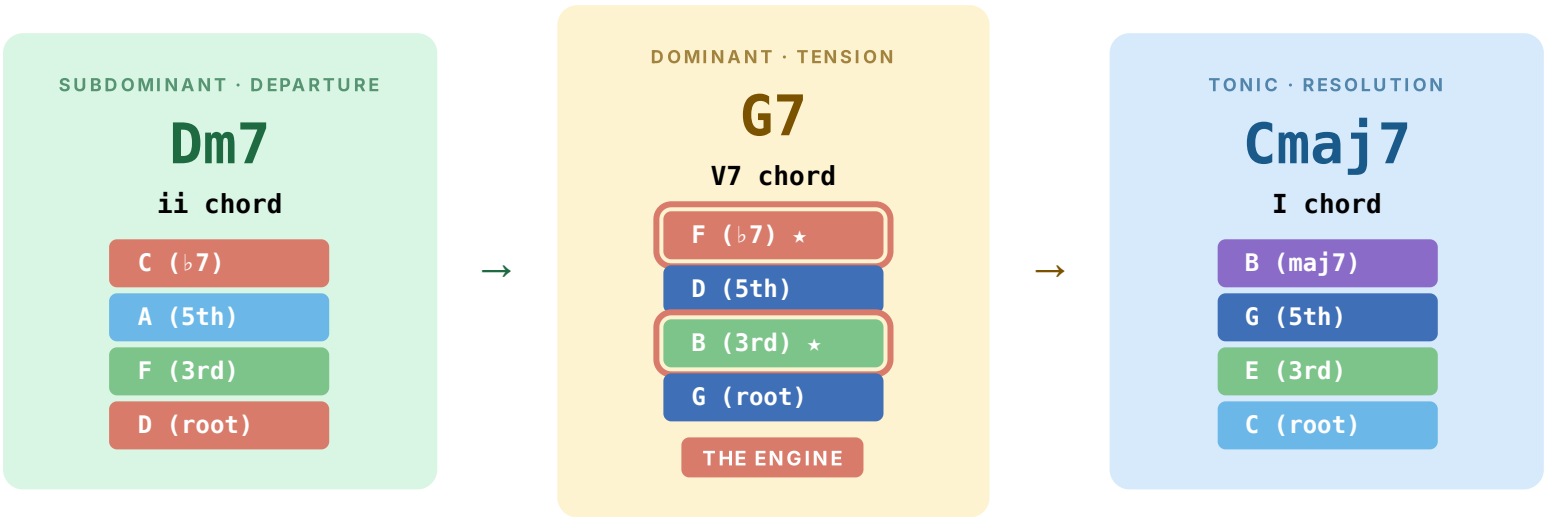


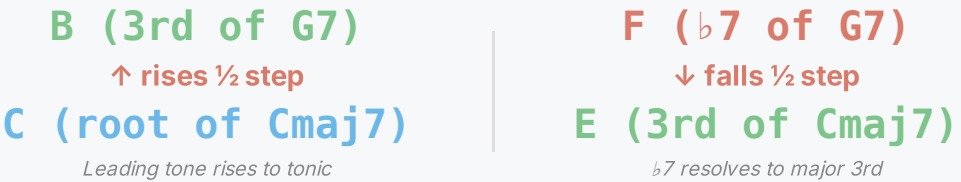
THE II-V-I EXPLAINED

The most fundamental harmonic progression in Western music — and why the tritone inside the V7 chord is the engine that makes everything work.

DM7 → G7 → CMAJ7 — THREE FUNCTIONS, ONE JOURNEY



VOICE LEADING — THE TRITONE COLLAPSES INWARD BY HALF STEPS



IN MINOR KEYS — BØ7 → E7 → AM7



The V chord (E7) stays MAJOR even in minor context — this is critical. The major 3rd (G♯) provides the leading tone that pulls up to A, the root of Am7. Without the raised 7th (G♯ from harmonic minor), the resolution loses its pull.

"The ii-V-I is the engine. Everything else is decoration, extension, or variation. Master this one motion and you understand the engine behind 95% of Western harmony."